



# UTSU Senate Policy & Procedures Manual

A collection of the policies and procedures set and maintained by the UTSU Senate.

Approved by the Board of Directors on 24 November 2023.

This document is distinct from UTSU's Bylaws. Where there are conflicts between the policies of the Senate and the UTSU bylaws, the bylaws shall take precedence.

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## **Introduction & Administration**

An introduction, administrative notes, and a template.

# Introduction

## WELCOME TO THE UTSU

Founded in 1901, the University of Toronto's Students' Union (UTSU) is the official student government for the more than 40,000 full time undergraduate students at the University of Toronto St. George campus. The UTSU is a student government and not-for-profit organization operating separately from the University of Toronto administration.

The UTSU is governed by the Board of Directors and managed by the executive committee. The Senate of the University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU) is an advisory body to the UTSU Board of Directors and Executive Committee. The Senate shall be responsible for advising the Board of Directors about issues of student life and issues which affect certain constituencies of the University of Toronto community.

This policy manual governs the Senate at the UTSU, supporting the operations of the organization.

The Senate shall act in accordance with the UTSU's Bylaws. Where there are conflicts between the policies of the Senate and bylaws, the bylaws shall take precedence.

## DEFINITIONS

1. The "Senate" shall refer to the representative organ of the UTSU's governance structure as described in Article 9 of the UTSU Bylaws.
2. A "senator" shall refer to any individual who is elected or appointed to the Senate and receives voting authority.
3. The "UTSU" or the "union" shall refer to the University of Toronto Students' Union.
4. The "Board of Directors" or "board" shall refer to the Board of Directors of the UTSU.
5. The "executive committee" shall refer to the executive committee of the UTSU as defined in Article 7 of the UTSU Bylaws.
6. The "management committee" shall refer to the management committee of the UTSU as defined in bylaw (7)(1.4).
7. The "membership" shall refer to the membership of the UTSU, subject to the relevant bylaws defining the organization's membership.
8. A "member" shall refer to any individual who is a member of the UTSU, but not a Senator or Director.
9. The "speaker" or "presiding officer" shall refer to the individual described with bylaw (9)(7) - *Presiding Officer*.
10. The "secretary" shall refer to the VP, Finance & Operations for the first meeting of each term, and a senator shall be elected by the senate to be the secretary for any proceeding meetings.

11. Senators shall serve from appointment until resignation, ineligibility, or death and until their successor shall be appointed.
12. The “bylaws” shall refer to the UTSU Bylaws.
13. A “regular meeting” shall refer to any meeting described in bylaw (9)(5).
14. A “special meeting” shall refer to any meeting described in bylaw (9)(6) .

## Administration

### Force of Policies

1. The following statements establish the importance of the Senate policies, including those contained within this policies and procedures manual.
  - a. All members of the UTSU seeking to participate in the processes of the Senate must familiarize themselves with this manual.
  - b. For questions about policies or for clarifications regarding interpretation, please contact the listed policy owner, the VP Finance & Operations, or the President.

### Scope of Manual

2. This manual applies to all senate activities and intends to provide a basis for consistent and appropriate decision-making on issues relating to the senate, including the following:
  - a. **Standing & Special Rules of Order (SSRO)**, which complement Robert's Rules by allowing for additional rules to be used in parliamentary UTSU meetings;
  - b. **Senate Policies (SENP)**, which outline the scope of Senate activities, the expectations of Senate members, and Senate membership eligibility requirements;
  - c. **Terms of Reference (STOR)**, which govern the formal committees of the UTSU, their members, meetings, finances, and any additional information;
3. All policies in this manual will be:
  - a. Presented in a common format using an approved header system;
  - b. Formally considered, approved, and recorded by the Senate;
  - c. Distributed to the Senate;
  - d. Made available in the UTSU Public shared drive and at [www.utsu.ca](http://www.utsu.ca); and
  - e. Kept current at all times.
4. The provisions of this policy manual are subject to any federal, provincial, or territorial laws that may prohibit or restrict their applicability.

### **Authority of the Senate**

5. The Senate shall have the authority to create or amend its policies, insofar as these decisions affect exclusively the activities of the Senate.
6. Where there are conflicts between the policies of the Senate and the policies of the Board, the policies of the Board shall take precedence.

### **Authority of the Board**

7. The Board shall respect the autonomy of the Senate in its activities and in its advisory capacity, per the bylaws of the UTSU.
8. The Board shall have the authority to ensure that Senate members are abiding by the People & Culture policies of the Board, including but not limited to: the Anti-Harassment policy; the Equity, Diversity and Inclusion Policy; and the Accessibility Policy.

|                                                                                   |         |                                                        |                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
|  | AREA    | CODE                                                   | [Code Title / Definition] |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 00_                                                    | [Name of Policy]          |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | [Position/Organ ultimately accountable for the policy] |                           |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | [i.e. Board of Directors, ____ Committee, etc]         |                           |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | [Date]                                                 | REVIEWED [Date]           |

## [AAAA-000] | Policy Template For Use

### PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. What is the overarching goal, rationale or purpose of this policy? What are some of the values and philosophies of the organization that inform this policy?
2. To whom does this policy apply to? Are there any specific provisions relating to the scope ? (i.e. does this policy only affect certain employment groups under certain circumstances?)

### POLICY

3. The substantive terms of the policy. In general, guidelines should outline the various provisions of the policy. The guidelines should be written in clear, concise, and accessible language. Policy should not be too prescriptive.
4. If the policy affects different employment categories or groups differently, the guidelines should reflect that.
  - a. Sub-points can be used to further elaborate on key aspects of the policy

### PROCEDURE

5. If your policy has an associated procedure, that procedure can be outlined in the same document. In general, procedures are required when something needs to be done consistently the same way, time after time.
6. Where the guidelines are more general, the procedure should be specific and prescriptive. Consider writing the procedure in such a way that it gives little-to-no room for error.

### CITATIONS AND APPENDICES

Note if the policy has any forms or supporting appendices and add citations of materials used in drafting the policy or procedure.



## **Senate Standing and Special Rules of Order (SRO)**

In addition to *Robert's Rules*, these rules help us govern meetings of the Senate of the UTSU.

|                                                                                   |         |                        |                               |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------|
|  | AREA    | SSRO                   | Senate Special Rules of Order |                |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 001                    | Meetings of the Senate        |                |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | UTSU Senate            |                               |                |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Meetings of the Senate |                               |                |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | 24 November 2023       | REVIEWED                      | 16 August 2024 |

## SSRO-001 | Senate Special Rules of Order

### PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. This policy outlines the Senate Special Rules of Order (SSRO) which govern meetings of the UTSU Senate.
2. These Special Rules of Order are meant to be used in conjunction with the most recent version of the UTSU's parliamentary authority, *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*.

### NOTICE & MEETINGS

3. As mentioned in Article 9, Section 5 of the bylaws, the Senate shall meet five (5) times annually, twice between September 1 and December 31, twice between January 1 and May 31, and once between June 1 and August 31. At the first meeting of the Senate, Senators shall determine all dates and times for the subsequent meetings of the year.
4. Notice of a regular meeting shall be provided to all Senators and Stakeholders at least 14 days prior to the meeting.
5. No later than seventy-two (72) hours prior to regular meetings of the Senate, the secretary shall deliver the meeting package electronically to members of the senate and stakeholders which provides all necessary information for the meeting, including:
  - a. The proposed agenda for approval;
  - b. A consent agenda which includes the minutes of the previous senate meeting, as well as the minutes of any other committee meetings or relevant subsidiaries which took place since the previous senate meeting;
  - c. Any other required appendices, depending on the month and meeting.
6. For special meetings of the Senate, the meeting package which provides all the necessary information shall be sent as soon as possible following notice. If possible, the meeting package shall be sent alongside notice for purposes of transparency.
  - a. Packages for special meetings are entirely subject to the needs of the meeting.
7. The 'meeting package deadline' and 'notice deadline' represent two separate obligations.

8. The VP, Finance & Operations shall serve as the secretary for the first meeting of the Senate of each term, and a senator shall be elected by the senate to be the secretary for any proceeding meetings.
9. The quorum of the Senate shall be one-third of the Senate membership.

### **LIMITS OF DEBATE**

10. Senators shall have two (2) speaking turns limited to three (3) minutes for each item. Consideration of each main motion shall be limited to fifteen minutes (which shall include the consideration of any motions that may be applied to the main motion; all applicable secondary motions remain in order) unless otherwise ordered by the Senate by a two-thirds vote without debate. This rule cannot be suspended.
11. All meetings of the senate shall not exceed two (2) hours from the set commencement time to adjournment. This rule cannot be suspended.
12. Senators shall be granted time as needed to present an item if required, at the discretion of the Speaker. Senators shall strive to present items concisely and clearly.
  - a. When non-senators offer relevant information to a discussion or are requested to give a presentation or commentary to the Senate, they shall be granted the right to speak and engage with the Senate at the discretion of the Speaker.
  - b. Procedure surrounding the granting of speaking privileges shall be conducted in a manner that is minimally intrusive to the flow of a meeting, and with the necessary consent of the Senate.
  - c. Generally, unless the presence of a non-senator is material to the substance of a meeting, speaking rights shall be reserved for members of the Senate.

### **PRESS, MEDIA, RECORDING & LIVE-STREAMING**

13. Members of the media and campus press are welcomed at meetings of the Senate, however all guests are required to seek recognition and announce their intentions prior to conducting any form of recording or photographing at meetings of the Senate.
14. Meetings of the Senate may be filmed, recorded, and/or live-streamed only by members of the media or with the consent of the Senate. If such actions are taken without the consent of the Senate, the Senate may act appropriately to relocate or clear the space.
15. Guests who take photo, video, or audio recordings at meetings of the Senate must provide a form of contact information so that those present can request that their likeness not be reproduced.

### **MEETINGS HELD ELECTRONICALLY**

16. Meetings may be held electronically in accordance with Article 6 of the bylaws.

|                                                                                   |         |                        |                                        |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------------------|----------------------------------------|----------------|
|  | AREA    | SSRO                   | Senate Special Rules of Order          |                |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 002                    | Meetings of Senate Standing Committees |                |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | Senate                 |                                        |                |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Meetings of the Senate |                                        |                |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | 24 November 2023       | REVIEWED                               | 16 August 2024 |

## SSRO-002 | Committees of the Senate

### PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. This policy outlines the special rules of order which govern meetings of the UTSU's Senate standing committees.
2. These Special Rules of Order are meant to be used in conjunction with the most recent version of the UTSU's parliamentary authority, *Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised*.

### NOTICE & MEETINGS

3. Committees shall meet in accordance with the policies established in their Terms of Reference.
4. Unless otherwise defined in the terms of reference of an individual committee, notice shall be given to members of a committee, no later than seventy-two (72) hours prior to the date and time in which a meeting is to be called.
5. After notice is given but no later than twenty-four (24) hours prior to a meeting, an agenda which includes any required supporting materials must be sent to members for review.

### RIGHTS, ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

6. The secretary shall be the steward for all committees of the Senate, and shall ensure that meetings are being scheduled, held, recorded, and minuted in a way which fulfills the obligations the UTSU has to be accountable to its members.
7. Unless already specified, committees shall elect a committee chair who calls, conducts, and minutes committee meetings until the conclusion of a committee's term of office. In specific circumstances, the chair can delegate administrative tasks.
8. The committee chair of each committee shall work with the secretary to ensure that their committee is always fully compliant and that meetings are being sufficiently held and minuted.

### MEETINGS HELD ELECTRONICALLY

9. Meetings may be held electronically in accordance with Article 6 of the bylaws.

## TERMS OF REFERENCE (TOR)

10. Terms of reference are extra to the UTSU's parliamentary authority, and specifically enable committees to conduct themselves in ways which are more informal and appropriate for the environment, as opposed to more formal Senate meetings.
11. Committees shall adopt and maintain a terms of reference, which follows a template provided by the governance committee, and accomplishes the following objectives:
  - a. Sets a detailed mandate for the committee empowering the committee to assume certain responsibilities;
  - b. Defines the roles and responsibilities of the committee chair, and outlines the procedure in which the roles are to be appointed if they are not already prescribed within the terms of reference or bylaws;
  - c. Outlines the methods in which meetings are to be called, held, and minuted;
  - d. Outlines the rules surrounding speaking rights, speaking turns, and the right for those who are not committee members to be present or speak at a meeting;
  - e. Outlines any procedures or other considerations as appropriate for holding meetings electronically, in open or closed session, or in executive session; and
  - f. Identifies and defines any other unique elements of the operations of a given committee which may otherwise be incompatible with *Robert's Rules*.

## RELEVANT RULES, LAWS & AUTHORITIES

12. At times, the mandate of a given committee may be necessarily affected by another governing document, precedent, or authority. In situations where other relevant rules or expectations apply, the committee chair shall work with the VP, Finance & Operations to ensure that their committee is meeting its obligations.

## **SENATE POLICIES (SENP)**

In addition to the Standing Rules Of Order, this will help organize the structures and functions of the Senate.

|                                                                                   |         |                              |                                    |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------|
|  | AREA    | SENP                         | Senate Policies                    |                |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 001                          | Mandate and Function of the Senate |                |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | Senate                       |                                    |                |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Senate and Senate Committees |                                    |                |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | 24 November 2023             | REVIEWED                           | 16 August 2024 |

## SENP-001 | Mandate & Functions of the Senate

### PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. This policy shall broadly govern the functions of the Senate, as well as the general roles and responsibilities of its members, expanding upon the mandate stipulated in Article 9 of the bylaws of the UTSU.

### MANDATE

2. The Senate shall advise the UTSU Board of Directors on issues of the U of T community in general, and of those faced by their constituency in particular. In doing so, they support the UTSU Board of Directors to respond to the needs of the broader campus community.

### GENERAL RESPONSIBILITIES

3. During Senate meetings, the Senate shall have the right to recommend the consideration of an issue regarding student life or issues which affect certain constituencies of the University of Toronto community to the Board of Directors.
  - a. The senate shall only discuss matters that pertain to the University of Toronto St. George Campus, and issues that concern the student body in regards to campus life.
4. Senators shall serve as advisory body to the UTSU.
  - a. While it is the mandate of the Board of Directors to make the final decision on all matters that affect the UTSU, the role of the Senate is to provide recommendations, advice and information to the Board of Directors on those specialized matters which relate to the purpose of the Senate. The Senate shall not give direction to the day-to-day administration or operations of the UTSU, nor shall the Senate request, without the approval of the Board of Directors, the preparation of any work assignments. Though the Board of Directors is not required to act upon recommendations brought forward by the Senate, all recommendations should be considered when such recommendations can be reasonably accommodated and do not place an unreasonable demand on available resources.

5. The Senate is collectively responsible for:
  - a. Advising the Board of Directors about issues of student life and issues which affect certain constituencies of the University of Toronto community;
  - b. Creating written reports to executive committees with suggested actionable items;
  - c. Holding minuted meetings at least 5 times per year;
  - d. Establishing Senate committees, and appointing Senators to those committees, based on their interests and capabilities;
  - e. Writing and presenting an annual report to the Board of Directors, including a summary transition report and presentation at the end of the term;
  - f. Senators provide a perspective on student issues and communicate back to the UTSU the decisions recommended by the Senate. The senate shall be responsible for recommending and bringing attention to issues faced by their constituents such as, but not limited to: residence and housing, campus safety, academic, accessibility needs, health and wellness on campus, student experience, etc., and;
  - g. The Senate shall have the ability to support member consultation processes undertaken by the UTSU.

## **INDIVIDUAL RESPONSIBILITIES**

6. Individual senators shall bear the following responsibilities:
  - a. The representation of their respective constituencies before the Senate;
  - b. Regular attendance to meetings of the Senate and any committees a given senator has been appointed to;
  - c. Attendance at the UTSU's annual general meeting or the sending of regrets if they should be unable to attend;
  - d. Any additional responsibilities deemed appropriate by the Senate, provided they do not contravene UTSU Bylaws Article 9, Section 10.
7. Senators may request meetings with the executive committee to discuss ongoing initiatives.



|                                                                                   |         |                                                  |                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
|  | AREA    | SEN                                              | Senate Policies        |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 002                                              | Senate Code of Conduct |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | Board of Directors, People and Culture Committee |                        |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Organization-at-large.                           |                        |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | 30 Apr 23                                        | REVIEWED [Date]        |

## SENP-002 | Senate Code of Conduct

### PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. The University of Toronto Students' Union shall expect that as a minimum standard of behaviour, all Senate members and others engaged with the UTSU shall at all times:
  - a. Conduct themselves in a reasonable and responsible manner;
  - b. Conduct themselves in a manner of mutual respect and understanding for all members of the University community;
  - c. Not engage in any activity or behaviour likely to bring the UTSU or the University of Toronto community into disrepute;
  - d. Conduct themselves in the spirit of the bylaws and policies of the UTSU;
  - e. Conduct themselves in a manner that does not discriminate, and by refraining from and actively opposing any form of discriminatory behaviour;
  - f. Treat all UTSU and university property with respect and shall not interfere with other peoples' the enjoyment of UTSU facilities or events;
  - g. Comply with the reasonable requests of UTSU and University of Toronto staff;
  - h. Adhere to the UTSU's and the university's health and safety policies and to any specific requirements that may apply in the environment one works within;
  - i. Fulfill the responsibilities of their office as outlined in the bylaws and policies, and;
  - j. Act honestly, carefully, diligently, and in good faith with a view to the best interests of the corporation.

|                                                                                   |         |                  |                          |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------------|--------------------------|----------------|
|  | AREA    | SENP             | Senate Policies          |                |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 003              | Membership of the Senate |                |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | Senate           |                          |                |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Senate Meetings  |                          |                |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | 24 November 2023 | REVIEWED                 | 16 August 2024 |

## SENP-003 | Membership of the Senate

### PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. This policy shall govern the membership eligibility and rights, election procedures and vacancies and discipline measures of the Senate.
2. This policy shall serve to ensure equitable representation and participation in the Senate.

### COMPOSITION

3. Unless otherwise provided in the UTSU's Bylaws, all members of the Senate are equally permitted to participate in senate meetings, debate, vote, propose motions and join established committees.
4. As mentioned in Article 9, Section 2 of the bylaws the Senate shall be composed of the following members, who shall be referred to as Senators:
  - a. Colleges:
    - i. Three (3) UTSU members from each of the following:
      1. Innis College,
      2. New College,
      3. St. Michael's College,
      4. Trinity College,
      5. University College,
      6. Victoria College, and
      7. Woodsworth College.
  - b. First-Entry Professional Faculties:
    - i. Two (2) UTSU members from each of the following:
      1. Architecture and Visual Studies,
      2. Kinesiology and Physical Education, and
      3. Music
    - ii. Three (3) UTSU members from:
      1. Applied Science and Engineering.
  - c. Second-Entry Professional Faculties:

- i. One (1) UTSU members from each of the following:
    - 1. Dentistry,
    - 2. Law
    - 3. Medicine,
    - 4. Nursing,
    - 5. Pharmacy, and
    - 6. The Toronto School of Theology.
- d. First Year Members.
  - i. Four (4) UTSU members in their first year of study.
- e. Commuter.
  - i. Two (2) UTSU members who are commuter students.
- f. Residence.
  - i. Two (2) UTSU members who live in University of Toronto residence(s).
- g. Mature Students and Student Parents.
  - i. Two (2) UTSU members who are mature students, student parents, or live in University of Toronto housing.
- h. International Students.
  - i. Four (4) UTSU members who are international students.
- i. First Generation Student.
  - i. One (1) UTSU member who is a first generation student i.e. the first member of their immediate family to be enrolled in a full-time undergraduate degree program. (1 member)
- j. Small and Specialized Programs.
  - i. One (1) UTSU member from each small and specialized program, as recognized by the Senate.
- 5. The Senate shall be empowered to increase further the membership of the Senate provided that the total number of positions, not inclusive of ex-officio members, does not exceed 75 and that all new Senate members are UTSU members.
- 6. Members of the UTSU Executive Committee, UTSU Board of Directors, and UTSU employees are ineligible to serve on the Senate.

#### **MEMBERSHIP OF EX-OFFICIO**

- 7. The speaker of the Senate shall be the speaker of the UTSU.
  - a. The speaker shall be in charge of conducting Senate meetings, ensuring meetings are conducted according to the Senate constitution and any other duties that the Senate may appoint from time to time

8. The secretary shall be responsible for creating meeting packages, minuting Senate meetings and ensuring the day-to-day business of the Senate is running according to the bylaws, rules of order, policies and terms of reference of the Senate.
9. The President of the UTSU, or a delegate, must attend all special and regular meetings of the Senate. The president must give notice of at least 72 hours and a name if a delegate is going on their behalf.
10. All executive committee members shall have the right to attend and debate during all Senate proceedings.

### **ELECTING SENATORS**

11. The inaugural Senate shall be elected by those present representing each of the aforementioned constituencies at an inaugural mass meeting.
12. The term of a senator shall be from their election until the following 31st of August.
- ~~13. The governance committee of the Senate shall develop a policy, which must be approved by the Senate, and later on by the Board of Directors, to how succeeding senators are elected.~~

### **ELECTING THE SECRETARY**

14. The Senate shall appoint a secretary at the first meeting following their election.
  - a. Senators that want to run, shall put their names forward and deliver a 30 second speech;
  - b. Senators will be elected by a majority vote.

### **VACANCIES**

15. The governance committee of the Senate shall develop and maintain a policy as to how the Senate shall appoint vacancies.

### **DISCIPLINE**

16. For matters of discipline, suspension, expulsion and integrity, the Senate shall follow the rules outlined in Article 10 of the UTSU Bylaws.
17. The Senate shall be empowered by a two-thirds (2/3) majority vote of the entire membership of the Senators to discipline a member.
18. The Senate may only discipline a member by:
  - a. Issuing a reprimand;
  - b. Suspending Senate membership; or
  - c. Expelling a member from the Senate.

|                                                                                   |         |                                    |                                   |          |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------|----------------|
|  | AREA    | SENP                               | Senate Policies                   |          |                |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 004                                | Standing Committees of the Senate |          |                |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | Senate                             |                                   |          |                |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Senate Meetings, Senate Committees |                                   |          |                |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | 24 November 2023                   |                                   | REVIEWED | 16 August 2024 |

## SEN-004 | Standing Committees of the Senate

### PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. The Senate was created to ensure that the UTSU remains deeply connected to the student body and will act as an arm's length advisory body.
2. Given its size, it offers more students ways to get involved and appoint its own committees based on the needs they identify. The purpose of this policy is to clearly establish the parameters committees must remain within when making decisions and conducting their general operations; it outlines the overriding rules that committees must consider prior to using their own terms of reference.

### STANDING COMMITTEES OF THE SENATE

3. The Senate, at minimum, is responsible for the election of senators to fill the following committees, in addition to any other committees it deems appropriate:
  - a. Annual report committee;
  - b. Governance committee.

### ELECTING SENATORS TO COMMITTEES

4. The Senate shall appoint committees and their chairs at their first meeting following their election.
  - a. Senators that want to run, shall put their names forward and deliver a 30 second speech;
  - b. Senators will be elected by a majority vote;
  - c. No Senator shall chair more than one committee.
5. Elections shall be conducted in-person or via an online platform following *Robert's Rules of Order*.
6. All **committees shall have a minimum of twelve (12) and a maximum of twenty (20) voting members who shall be selected among the senators.**
  - a. Senators may join more than one committee

- b. Senators can abstain from participating in committees.
- 7. In the absence of the Committee Chair, the secretary shall be empowered of all the duties and responsibilities of the Chair during Senate Committee Meetings.

### **CALLING AND CONDUCTING COMMITTEE MEETINGS**

- 8. When calling meetings of committees, the chair shall give 72 hour notice for the time and date, and 24 hours notice for the agenda and any other package items.
- 9. Unless otherwise specified in the terms of reference of a committee, or by committee vote, all committee meetings shall be held in open session.
- 10. All meetings of committees shall be held using *Robert's Rules of Order*.

### **TERMS OF REFERENCE**

- 11. The Senate shall be responsible for drafting new terms of reference for any additional committees it creates provided they do not interfere with bylaw Article 9, Section 10.
- 12. Each committee shall be responsible for maintaining its own terms of reference. Terms of reference govern most aspects of a committee's operations. They should include the scope and mandate, duties and responsibilities, membership, meeting procedures, decision-making expectations, and customs of the committee.
- 13. Changes to a committee's terms of reference must first be made by a resolution of the committee responsible for its maintenance, and then further recommended to the Senate by its governance committee.
- 14. The terms of reference for each committee must include its date of inception, the date it was last reviewed by the committee, and a record of each time it was amended.

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
|  | AREA    | SENP                                          | Senate Policies         |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 005                                           | Membership Selection    |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | Senate                                        |                         |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Senate membership, Senate application process |                         |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | 25 May 2025                                   | REVIEWED September 2025 |

## SENP-005 | Membership Selection

### PREAMBLE & SCOPE

1. The Senate of the University of Toronto Students' Union (UTSU) acts as an arm's length advisory body to the UTSU Board of Directors. It ensures the UTSU remains grounded in student representation by engaging a broad range of members across the University of Toronto community.
2. This policy outlines the procedure for selecting members of the Senate, including the application process, inaugural meeting protocol, and confirmation of membership.

### MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION PROCESS

3. The Senate application shall be opened and closed at the discretion of the Vice-President, Finance and Operations (VPFO).
  - a. Applications shall be submitted via an official online form.
  - b. Only current University of Toronto students who are paying members of the UTSU are eligible to apply.
  - c. Applicants may indicate their preferred constituency and an optional secondary choice. Members shall ensure that they are affiliated with their preferred constituency and their optional secondary choice.
  - d. Membership is determined on a first come, first served basis at the inaugural meeting, which shall be the first regular meeting of the Senate between September 1 and December 31 annually. Submission of an application does not guarantee a seat.

### INAUGURAL SENATE MEETING & ELECTION PROCESS

4. Only the applicants, the executive committee, and the speaker shall be invited to attend the inaugural meeting of the Senate, by the Vice President of Finance and Operations, conducted via an online platform.
5. During this meeting, the VPFO shall facilitate the election process and oversee the filling of all Senate seats.
6. The Speaker shall chair the meeting, and provide procedural advice as to how the conduct of the election will be conducted.

7. Interested applicants shall volunteer for available positions, as per the chair's instruction, during the meeting, and seats will be filled based on who volunteers first in real time.
8. Attendance at the inaugural meeting does not guarantee a Senate seat.
9. Those in attendance who volunteer, and have satisfied all other requirements, and fill a seat, shall be declared elected to said position by the chair, provided that they complete and submit a Senate Membership Agreement within the established timelines as provided by the VPFO.

#### **CONFIRMATION OF SENATE MEMBERSHIP**

10. Following the inaugural meeting, all individuals who successfully claim a seat shall complete and submit a Senate Membership Agreement, provided by the UTSU.
11. Only upon receipt of a signed agreement shall an individual be considered a Senator for the academic year.

#### **VACANCIES IN SENATE MEMBERSHIP**

12. In the event of an incomplete election, or of a vacancy, the Senate may fill that vacancy at their pleasure, at any regular meeting, in accordance with an election procedure as provided for by the chair.



## **SENATE TERMS OF REFERENCE (STOR)**

The policies which govern committees and subsidiaries.

|                                                                                   |         |                          |                                 |                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|--------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------|
|  | AREA    | STOR                     | Senate Terms of Reference       |                |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 001                      | Establishing Terms of Reference |                |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | Senate                   |                                 |                |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Committees of the Senate |                                 |                |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | November 24, 2023        | REVIEWED                        | 16 August 2024 |

## STOR-001 | Establishing Terms of Reference

### PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. This policy outlines the necessary components for the terms of reference that are established and maintained by the committees of the Senate.
2. This policy affects the committees and their respective relationships with the Senate and the organization at-large.
3. This policy describes how roles, responsibilities, and powers of committees and their members should be described and enumerated in terms of reference.

### MEMBERSHIP

4. Membership shall be composed only of senators. Terms of reference may set additional membership requirements.

### GENERAL DUTIES

5. Unless already specified, committees shall elect a committee chair who calls, conducts, and minutes committee meetings until the conclusion of a committee's term of office. In specific circumstances, the chair can delegate administrative tasks.
6. The committee chair, in consultation with the committee itself, shall be responsible for ensuring a committee meets all of its responsibilities according to the bylaws, policies, and terms of reference of the UTSU.

### TERMS OF REFERENCE

7. Committees shall adopt and maintain a terms of reference which provides the duties and responsibilities of the committee and its members, including any financial, legal, or operational obligations not already defined in the organization's bylaws or policies.
8. Specifically, and in addition to the above, terms of reference shall include:
  - a. the individual expectations of the committee chair;
  - b. how a committee plans to give notice for and conduct meetings, as well as how agendas, recordings, and minutes are to be created, sent, and stored;
  - c. under what authority the committee holds its powers, how the committee is affected by other relationships, and how the committee reports to the senate.

9. Committees shall ensure that their terms of reference are consistent with their mandate, and that they do not conflict with the bylaws and policies of the UTSU.

## **REPORTING**

10. Following the resolved recommendation of a committee, the chair of a given committee shall be prepared to give a report to the senate which outlines the basis for the decision.

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|-------------------------|---------------------------|----------------|
|  | AREA    | STOR                    | Senate Terms of Reference |                |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 002                     | Annual Report Committee   |                |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | Senate                  |                           |                |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Annual Report Committee |                           |                |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | 24 November 2023        | REVIEWED                  | 16 August 2024 |

## STOR-002 | Annual Report Committee

### PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. The annual report committee is responsible for keeping track of all Senate business throughout the calendar year
2. The annual report committee is also responsible for writing a detailed report to the board of directors.

### MEMBERSHIP

3. The Membership of the Annual Report Committee is as follows:
  - a. A minimum of three (3) and a maximum of ten (10)-directors; with one senator being elected as the chair of the Senate Annual Report Committee.
  - b. The VP Finance & Operations, or their designate, shall serve as a non-voting member.

### DUTIES & RESPONSIBILITIES

4. The annual report committee shall produce an annual report for submission to the UTSU in March of each calendar year.
5. The annual report shall contain, at a minimum, the following:
  - a. Major resolutions of the Senate in addition to policy and programming recommendations made by the Senate over the past calendar year
  - b. Appendices containing
    - i. The composition and membership of the Senate;
    - ii. The meeting schedule over the last calendar year;
    - iii. Attendance details throughout the year.
  - c. A summary of the changes in Senate membership
  - d. A list of committees as well as their compositions and members

- e. A detailed description of the activities conducted by the other committees of the Senate
  - f. Any other material deemed necessary or appropriate by the annual report committee, the Senate, or the Board of Directors
- 6. The chair shall be responsible for creating the agenda on the advice of committee members, and uploading it to the shared drive after meetings. The chair shall be responsible for ensuring minutes are uploaded to the shared drive.

## **MEETING & RECOMMENDATION-MAKING PROCEDURES**

- 7. The annual report committee shall be struck by the incoming Senate at their first meeting in September of each year.
- 8. The annual report committee shall meet a minimum of three (3) times beginning no later than September and ending in March of each year.
  - a. By the end of the last session, members must have the annual report ready for submission to the board
- 9. In serious and time-sensitive situations, the chair may call an annual report committee meeting with a minimum of 24 hours' notice and sending of the meeting package.
- 10. Personnel and visitors may be invited to annual report committee meetings at the request of members by and at the discretion of the chair. These personnel and visitors shall have speaking rights, but shall only be invited for the purpose of presenting information about agenda items which would otherwise not be heard.
- 11. Members shall have two (2) speaking turns limited to three (3) minutes for each item.
- 12. Members shall be granted additional time or times as needed for items, if required, at the discretion of the speaker. Members shall strive to present items concisely and clearly.
- 13. Agendas and minutes from each meeting shall be uploaded by the chair to the shared board drive.

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|----------------------|---------------------------|----------------|
|  | AREA    | STOR                 | Senate Terms of Reference |                |
|                                                                                   | POLICY  | 003                  | Governance Committee      |                |
|                                                                                   | OWNERS  | Senate               |                           |                |
|                                                                                   | AFFECTS | Governance Committee |                           |                |
| INTRODUCED                                                                        |         | 24 November 2023     | REVIEWED                  | 16 August 2024 |

## STOR-003 | Governance Committee

### PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. The Governance Committee is responsible for planning and recommendations related to the Senate policies, bylaws, and other internal regulation.

### MEMBERSHIP

2. The membership of the governance committee is as follows:
  - a. A minimum of three (3) and a maximum of ten (10)-directors; with one senator being elected as the chair of the Senate Governance Committee.
  - b. The VP Finance & Operations, or their designate, shall serve as a non-voting member.

### DUTIES & RESPONSIBILITIES

3. In the first year of the senate, the committee shall be responsible for recommending to the senate a policy on how senators are elected in all subsequent years.
4. The governance committee shall review Senate policies, bylaws, and other internal regulations.
5. The Senate may evaluate and make recommendations on changes to said regulations.
6. The chair shall be responsible for creating the agenda on the advice of committee members, and uploading it to the shared drive after meetings. The chair shall be responsible for ensuring minutes are uploaded to the shared drive.

### MEETING & RECOMMENDATION-MAKING PROCEDURES

7. The governance committee shall be struck by the incoming senate members at their first meeting in September of each year.
8. The governance committee shall meet in open session unless determined otherwise by the committee or the bylaws and policies.

9. In serious and time-sensitive situations, the chair may call a governance committee meeting with a minimum of 24 hours' notice and sending of the meeting package.
10. Personnel and visitors may be invited to governance committee meetings at the request of members by and at the discretion of the chair. These personnel and visitors shall have speaking rights, but shall only be invited for the purpose of presenting information about agenda items which would otherwise not be heard.
11. Members shall have two (2) speaking turns limited to three (3) minutes for each item.
12. Members shall be granted additional time or times as needed for items, if required, at the discretion of the speaker. Members shall strive to present items concisely and clearly.
13. Agendas and minutes from each meeting shall be uploaded by the chair to the shared board drive.